

\$5 Challenge Exercise

Project Summary:

What would you do to earn money if all you had was five dollars and one week?

This assignment is designed to spur students to identify opportunities on campus, and in the greater Ames/Des Moines community - to be entrepreneurial, if only in a rudimentary sense. You are encouraged to challenge your assumptions and spend some time closely observing the real-life day-to-day problems that people around you are experiencing in order to identify and create solutions to these problems.

Your team members will each contribute \$1 as seed capital for your fledgling enterprise, and yes, this is a hard restriction on the financial resources you can invest in this endeavor. However, it is important to see beyond these limited monetary resources and identify the other tangible and intangible assets your group can bring to the table in finding and exploiting opportunities. What unique knowledge or skills do you all possess, what insights into underlying issues/problems in the world around you, what connections, networks, or access to other resources do you possess? Leverage everything at your disposal.

Actionable Details:

This exercise will officially commence on Friday, September 4th. Until then, you are free to brainstorm ideas for this project. It is important to note that, in addition to the 5% impact this exercise has on your overall grade in class, the winners of this challenge (as determined by the instructor) will receive 3 extra credit points in the class.

Students will have until Friday, September 18th to work on this challenge. On Friday, students will then present their findings in a **3 minute presentation** to the class. This presentation should detail the various ideas they came up with, the rationale for the one they chose, the process of executing on their idea, and how things actually worked out. It will be important to succinctly summarize this information in a concise presentation that **does not exceed 10 slides**.

Assessment:

Teams will be graded according to their effort, perseverance, creativity, identification of a viable problem, and whether or not they were actually able to deliver a legitimate solution worth paying for. The rubric for this exercise has been published on Canvas for your reference. Good faith efforts on this project will be respected and rewarded, even if such efforts ultimately fail in execution. Entrepreneurship is often facilitated by trial-and-error learning, so don't be dismayed by initial failures. Your ability to persevere through setbacks may be critical to ultimate success on this project. Good luck!